seam.

STOP LOSING JOBS TO MISSED CALLS AND SLOW REPLIES

What a tradie website needs so visitors turn into calls. A free guide for trades.

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READ THIS FIRST

THE JOB IS DECIDED BEFORE YOU CALL BACK

Someone needs a tradie. They search on their phone, tap a couple of results, and ring whoever looks right and answers.

I'm Heath. I've worked in digital marketing for more than 10 years and built over 100 websites for Australian businesses. I do the work myself, here in Australia.

Most tradie websites I look at aren't ugly. They just leak. The number is hard to find on a phone, the form goes to an inbox nobody checks until Sunday, and a missed call means the customer rings the next business on the list. None of that shows up as a problem. The phone is just quieter than it should be.

What's in here

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Who it's for: plumbers, electricians, builders, landscapers, roofers, cleaners and anyone else who gets work from people searching on their phone. Start with the phone test on page 4. It takes five minutes.

THE REAL PROBLEM

FIND THE LEAK FIRST

An enquiry from your website has to get through three steps. A nicer design only helps with the middle one.

FOUND
People nearby find you on Google

→

TRUSTED
They believe you can do the job

→

ANSWERED
They reach you, and hear back fast

If one step is broken, the others can't make up for it. Work out where yours is leaking:

WHAT YOU'RE SEEING	THE LEAK	START WITH
Hardly anyone finds your website on Google	Found	Fix 2
People visit, but few call or fill in the form	Trusted	Fix 1 and Fix 3
You miss calls while you're on the tools	Answered	Fix 4
Form enquiries sit for hours, or days	Answered	Fix 5

Where to find the numbers

Look at your missed calls for the last week, and your website form enquiries for the last month. Then check how long each one waited for a reply. Most tradies are surprised by both numbers.

Do this now: scroll back through your phone's missed calls from last week. How many did you call back? How many got the job somewhere else?

FIX 1

THE PHONE TEST

Most people looking for a tradie are on their phone. So check your website on yours, as if you've never heard of your business.

Open it on your phone and tick what's true without scrolling:

- [ ] I can tell what you do in the first line
- [ ] I can tell which areas you work in
- [ ] Your phone number is at the top, and tapping it starts a call
- [ ] There's one obvious button: call, or get a quote
- [ ] The page loads quickly on mobile data, not just on your Wi-Fi
- [ ] There's a real photo of your work or your team, not stock images
- [ ] I can see a reason to trust you: reviews, licence, insurance, years in business

Rewrite the top of your home page

TELLS ME NOTHING

Welcome to our website. Quality workmanship you can trust.

TELLS ME WHAT TO DO NEXT

Blocked drains and hot water, Frankston to Mornington. 7 days. Tap to call.

Use this formula: **what you do + where you do it + how to reach you.** Leave out anything every competitor could also say.

Score: anything under 7 out of 7 is costing you calls. These are quick fixes, and they help every visitor you'll ever get.

FIX 2

GET FOUND FOR THE JOBS YOU WANT

People don't search for your business name. They search for the job and the suburb: "hot water repair Frankston".

Google can only show your website for a search if a page on it clearly matches. One "Services" page listing everything rarely does.

Basic local SEO that's worth doing

1. **A page for each main service.** Blocked drains, hot water, gas fitting. Each one says what you do, how it works and roughly what affects the price.
2. **Pages for the suburbs you want work in.** Real ones, mentioning local streets, housing types or problems, not the same text with the suburb swapped.
3. **A clear page title on each page.** Use the formula: service + suburb + business name. "Hot Water Repairs Frankston | Banksia Bay Plumbing".
4. **The same name, address and phone** on your website, your Google Business Profile and anywhere else you're listed.
5. **Link your website and Google Business Profile** to each other, and keep your hours and service areas up to date on both.
6. **Connect Google Search Console.** It's free, and it shows which searches already find you.

Be patient: new pages usually take weeks or months to rank. Start with the services that make you the most money.

FIX 3

MAKE IT EASY TO GET IN TOUCH

Every extra step between "I need this fixed" and talking to you is a chance for them to go back to Google.

On every page

- A tap-to-call number at the top, on every page, not just the contact page
- A short quote form that's easy to fill in with one thumb
- Your hours, and what happens after hours

Keep the form short

TOO MUCH

Title, first name, last name, company, address, postcode, budget, how did you hear about us, preferred contact time, message.

ENOUGH TO CALL THEM BACK

Name, mobile, suburb, and "what's the job?" A photo upload is a bonus.

You can ask the rest on the phone. A form that asks for everything up front gets fewer enquiries.

Show what happens next

Under the button, say it plainly: "I'll call you back within the hour on weekdays." People are more likely to enquire when they know what to expect.

Test it: fill in your own form from your phone tonight. Did it go through? Where did it land, and how long until you'd have seen it?

FIX 4

DON'T LET A MISSED CALL BECOME A LOST JOB

You can't answer up a ladder or under a house. The problem isn't missing the call. It's what the caller does next.

Plenty of people won't leave a voicemail. When nobody answers, they go back to the search results and ring the next tradie. By the time you call back, the job can already be booked.

Close the gap

1. **Send a text back when you miss a call.** An automatic text tells them you've seen it and asks what they need. It keeps them waiting for you instead of ringing someone else.
2. **Fix your voicemail greeting.** Say your business name, that you're on a job, and when you'll call back. Ask them to text the job and suburb.
3. **Call back in batches.** Pick set times: smoko, lunch and knock-off. Same times every day.
4. **Ask how they found you.** Write it down. It's the simplest way to know what's working.

A MISSED-CALL TEXT YOU CAN USE

"Hi, it's Dan from Banksia Bay Plumbing. Sorry I missed your call, I'm on a job. What do you need a hand with, and what suburb are you in? I'll call you back shortly."

Automated texts should name your business and give people a way to opt out of anything marketing-related. Keep missed-call texts about their enquiry.

FIX 5

REPLY BEFORE THEY RING SOMEONE ELSE

Someone who fills in your form has often filled in two or three others. The first tradie to reply well has a real head start.

You don't need to be on your phone all day. You need enquiries to find you, wherever you are.

Set it up once

1. **Send every website enquiry to your phone by SMS**, not just your email. You'll see it between jobs, not on Sunday night.
2. **Send an instant reply to the customer.** A short automatic text or email: you've got it, and when you'll be in touch.
3. **Put every enquiry in one place.** Calls, texts, form enquiries and missed calls, so nothing slips through.
4. **Reply at your check times,** and move it to a phone call as soon as you can.

AN INSTANT REPLY YOU CAN USE

"Thanks for getting in touch with Banksia Bay Plumbing. I've got your enquiry and I'll call you back within the hour on weekdays. If it's urgent, call me on 0400 000 000."

The test: how long did your last five form enquiries wait for a reply? If any waited until the next day, fix this first.

THE CHECKLIST

YOUR WEBSITE CHECKLIST

Go through it on your phone. Every box you can't tick is an enquiry going somewhere else.

- [ ] The top of the home page says what you do, where, and how to reach you
- [ ] Tap-to-call at the top of every page
- [ ] Loads quickly on mobile data
- [ ] Real photos of your work, and reviews you can show
- [ ] Licence and insurance details where people can see them
- [ ] A page for each main service, and for the suburbs you want work in
- [ ] Clear page titles: service + suburb + business name
- [ ] Website and Google Business Profile link to each other, with matching details
- [ ] A short quote form: name, mobile, suburb, the job
- [ ] Missed calls get a text back
- [ ] Form enquiries get an instant reply
- [ ] Every enquiry comes to your phone by SMS

The one number to track

Enquiries a month, and how many you answered within the hour

Ask every new customer "How did you hear about me?" and write it down. It picks up what the apps miss.

RATHER HAVE IT DONE FOR YOU?

A WEBSITE THAT CATCHES EVERY ENQUIRY

Everything in this guide works if you do it yourself. If you'd rather stay on the tools, this is what I build.

SMART WEBSITE

Built for trades

$99 a week + GST

- A website built for your business, with no cap on pages, and basic local SEO
- Missed calls get an automatic text back
- Form enquiries get an instant automatic reply
- Every enquiry (calls, texts, forms and missed calls) sent to your phone by SMS

No setup fee. Month to month, no lock-in.

Want more work coming in? Growth

$235 a week + GST

Your Smart Website, plus social media, full local SEO and Google Business Profile management, and Google Ads or Meta Ads run for you.

Billed weekly. Ad spend is separate and paid directly to the platform. I can't promise you a set number of leads, but you'll deal with me directly, and nothing gets offshored.

Want to talk it through?

Reply to the email this guide came with, or call me on **0402 642 746**. The details are at **seammedia.com.au/smart-website**.

Prices in AUD as at November 2026. Ecommerce, custom features and complex builds are quoted separately. This guide is general information, and results vary between businesses. Banksia Bay Plumbing is a made-up example.